

Question 25 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the role of feedback and counselling in an HRD system.

Answer

Feedback and counselling convert data (appraisal, potential, training results) into understanding and behavioural change. They are the human process that makes other subsystems work.

- 1. Feedback – information for improvement:** Specific, timely, behaviour-focused information on what was effective and what was not.
- 2. Two-way nature:** Employees also feed back on resources, role clarity and support needed.
- 3. Counselling – helping relationship:** A manager or counsellor helps the employee explore problems, feelings, career issues and action plans in a confidential, respectful setting.
- 4. Link to appraisal:** Without a counselling discussion, appraisal is a form, not development.
- 5. Motivation and trust:** Skilled counselling builds HRD climate; harsh or absent feedback destroys it.
- 6. Corrective and developmental:** Addresses performance problems early and also stretches high performers.
- 7. Career counselling:** Aligns aspirations with organisational reality.
- 8. Skill requirement:** Listening, empathy, confrontation of issues, and goal setting—HRD must train managers in these skills.

***Conclusion.** Feedback and counselling are the heart of an HRD system because development happens through dialogue, not through forms alone.*